

DPSH MUN 2026

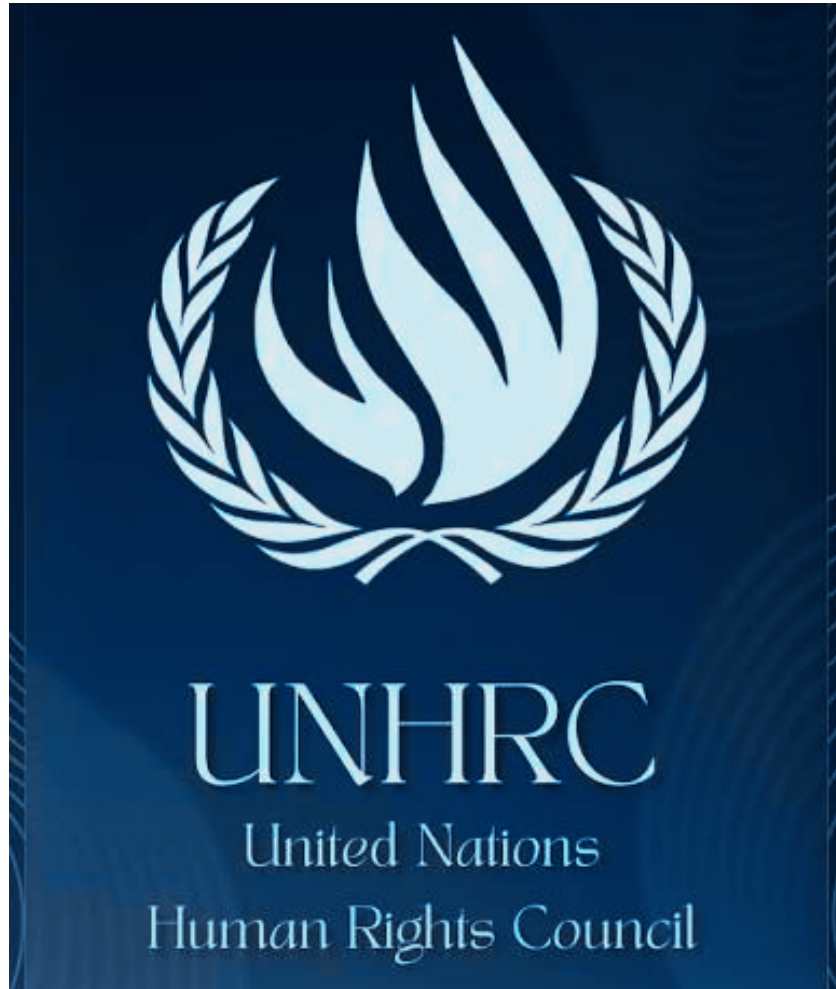
UNHRC

Safeguarding rights, Fostering Equality.

UNITED NATIONS HUMAN RIGHTS COUNCIL



DPSH MUN 2026



AGENDA:

“The Impact of Artificial Intelligence-Enabled Warfare
on the Protection of Human Rights in Armed
Conflicts.”

Letter from the Executive Board

We are honoured to serve in the faculty of the Executive Board for the duration of this simulation of the United Nations Human Rights Council at DPSHMUN 2026. The Human Rights Council was established by Resolution 60/251 of the General Assembly and plays an integral part in the international human rights movement, as it is the primary intergovernmental body within the United Nations that deals with the issue of safeguarding human rights.

This Background Guide has been meticulously crafted to catalyze furthering your research, and we hope that after perusing this guide, you will be well equipped to delve into the intricacies of the Human Rights Council, and specifically the complexities of our agenda. Keep in mind that this Background Guide is in no way exhaustive in nature, and is only intended to provide an elementary understanding of the agenda at hand.

In addition to this, we would like to stress that while this Guide may prompt you in a certain direction, by no means does that validate nor does it refute that perspective, and thus, we emphasise delegates doing extensive research into their foreign policies. While new ideas are inherently disruptive, they are far less disruptive than a world dominated by stereotypes and regional instability. We urge delegates to consider this while brainstorming ideas for sustained improvement in human rights, and not to refrain from proposing innovative solutions, whether temporary or permanent, out of fear of being too disruptive.

Delegates are encouraged to research in much greater depth than is covered in the Guide, not only on the agenda but also on past actions by international organisations, actions taken domestically, and their country's policies and perspectives, both domestically and internationally. This guide cannot and will not be accepted as proof of statements during committee proceedings under any circumstances.

We understand that an MUN can be an overwhelming experience for beginners, but it must be clearly understood that our aspirations for the delegates as the Executive Board are not that they are experienced or very eloquent. Rather, we wish to see delegates manage differences of opinion and conflicts of interest while extending foreign policy to present comprehensive solutions without compromising on their portfolio's self-interests and initiating consensus-building.

We suggest delegates examine each human rights topic they deal with in 4 dimensions:

- a) Social: Impact on societal norms and relationships
- b) Political: Effect of power structures and governance

- c) Economic: Influence of financial systems and wealth inequalities
- d) Legal: Role of judicial systems and legislature

Hopefully, this will have guided you to a comprehensive understanding of the agenda at hand, and you will be able to present sensitive and nuanced information in a setting such as this. With that in mind, we look forward to witnessing invigorating debate and vibrant solutions. All the best!

Abhyudit Rajesh
Chairperson

Hasini Rao Kasuganti
Chairperson

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Rapporteur

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Proceedings of the Committee

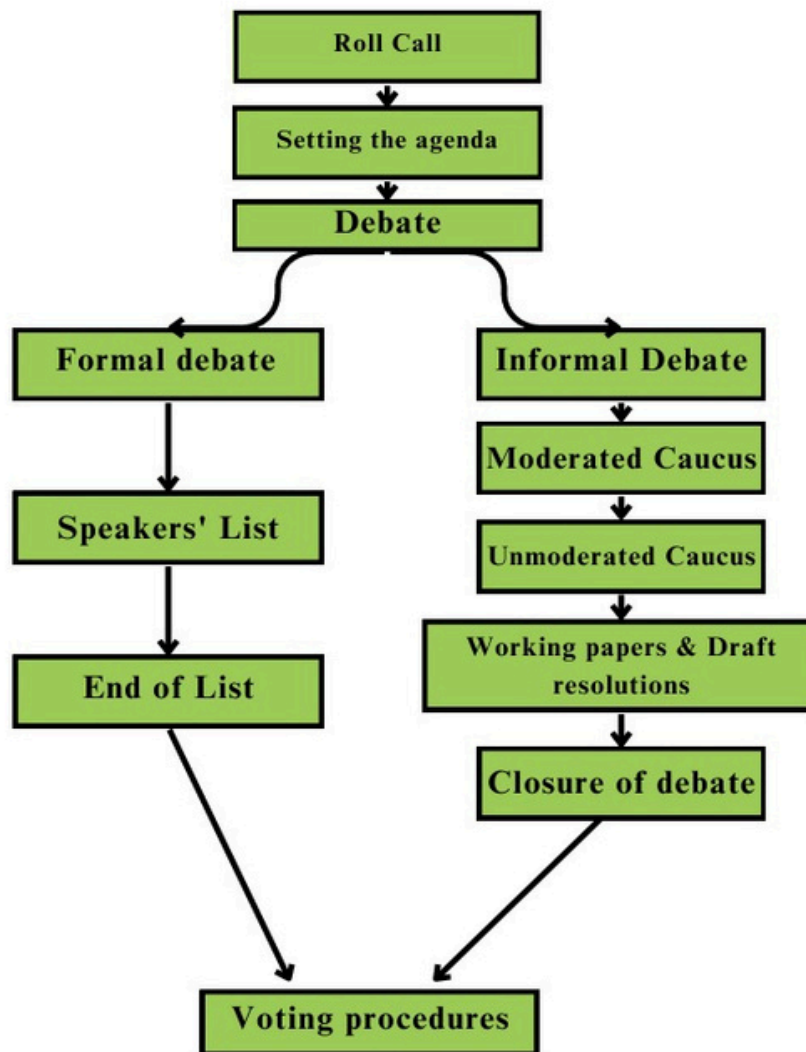
This section of the Background Guide is aimed at explaining the rules of procedure that we will be following for the entire duration of the conference. We would like to emphasise that the deciding authority for the rules of procedure will be the Executive Board. If a delegate is informed otherwise of any procedure not discussed in the background guide or in committee, we would request that you clarify immediately with the Executive Board before taking any substantial action.

As the Executive Board, we have decided to follow the UNA-USA Rules of Procedure, with certain modifications. If any delegate feels that the Executive Board's decision on a particular procedural matter was both contrary to the UNA-USA Rules of Procedure and unsatisfactory to the committee as a whole, the Secretariat would be the final decisive authority for the matter.

Decorum:

Before we begin discussing the rules of procedure, the Executive Board would like to stress that the maintenance of decorum is of utmost importance. This would include being respectful and courteous to all Secretariat, Executive Board, Organising Committee and International Press members as well as your fellow delegates at **ALL** times. This includes giving the speaker their due respect by refraining from engaging in parallel discussions or cross-talk, treating everyone with respect, using appropriate language both inside and outside the committee, and respecting personal boundaries.

The following chart details the flow of debate:



Voting:

Before we begin discussing the flow of debate, we must first have a thorough understanding of the voting procedure. In the UN, we have two types of voting:

a) ***Procedural Voting***: ALL delegates **MUST** vote either in favour (yes) or against (no). Delegates do **not** have the option to abstain from this type of voting, regardless of their voting stance. Procedural voting is used for all matters of procedure, such as motions.

b) ***Substantive Voting***: ALL delegates **MUST** vote in. However, in matters of substantive voting, depending on the delegates' voting stance, in addition to the options of in favour

and against, delegates may have the additional option to abstain. Substantive voting is used when the committee is voting to act with a substantial impact on the world as a whole, like passing documentation.

Roll Call and Voting Stance:

Simply put, roll call is the UN's way of taking attendance. When answering roll calls, delegates have two options, which affect their options in substantive voting.

There are two options, called the *voting stance*, available for delegates in roll call:

- a) ***Present***: This presents the opportunity to abstain from substantive votes
- b) ***Present and Voting***: This means that the delegate will be taking part in all voting, and as a result does not have the option to abstain (withdraw/not take part) from taking part in matters of substantive voting **ONLY**.

Please note: While your voting stance itself does not affect your marking in any way, your vote itself could potentially affect your marking, so choose your vote wisely.

Setting the Agenda:

This is a formality during any session of the HRC, usually used when multiple agendas are slated for discussion. Obviously, for fruitful discussion to take place, the Council needs to focus on one specific agenda item, and thus one agenda item is introduced at a time.

Debate:

There are two types of debate:

- a) ***Formal debate***: This usually encompasses the General Speakers List and is used to discuss the agenda as a whole.
- b) ***Informal debate***: This is used when the committee wants to discuss specific subtopics under the agenda, or have informal discussions in general.

General Speakers List (GSL) and Caucuses

The GSL is an exhaustive list, with speeches usually used to discuss the agenda as a whole. The speaking time can be set to any number of seconds, with 90 seconds being the standard. However, delegates may choose any time as they see fit for the committee.

To be recognised for the GSL, a delegate needs only raise their placard or send a chit to the EB. Delegates can speak an unlimited number of times through the GSL. Delegates must remember that the end of the GSL marks the end of debate, which would mean that debate has been tabled. While the committee session has not necessarily ended, nothing further can be discussed once debate has been tabled.

There are two types of caucuses in MUNs, and both are a form of informal debate. They are:

a) ***Moderated Caucuses:*** These are discussions about a determined subtopic on the agenda, with a maximum total time of 20 minutes, and an individual speaker time that is both divisible by the total time, as well as less than or equal to the individual speaker time for GSLs.

b) ***Unmoderated Caucuses:*** These are essentially breaks where delegates may interact with each other freely and lobby. They only require the total duration, as delegates do not address the committee. We would recommend that delegates use this time to lobby, further your research, or draft documentation.

Points

In an MUN, points are used to ask questions, express discomfort, and communicate with the EB. They are of 4 types, and have been listed from highest priority of recognition to the lowest priority of recognition:

a) ***Personal Privilege:*** This is the only point that can interrupt a speaker. It is used to address a personal discomfort, request, or issue. To avoid interrupting the speaker, we

would request anyone unable to hear another delegate's speech raise their placard and place their index finger on their ear to communicate that you are facing audibility issues.

b) ***Point of Order***: This is used for highlighting a procedural error or a factual inaccuracy.

Logical fallacies will not be entertained.

c) ***Point of Parliamentary Inquiry***: This is used to clarify any questions about proceedings

or rules of procedure and is directed to the Executive Board.

d) ***Point of Information***: This is used to ask questions to other delegates in relation to a speech which they have just made. Point of Information can also be used through chits.

Yields

In formal debate, if a speaker finishes their speech within their individual allotted time and has some time left over, they can choose to yield that time in the following manner:

a) ***Yield to Another Delegate***: Giving the remainder of your time so another delegate can speak. Note that the speaker would have to speak at that moment, and the time cannot be added to their individually allotted speaking time. Considering this, to avoid putting delegates on the spot, delegates need to be informed in advance that time will be yielded to them by the delegate

b) ***Yield to Points of Information***: Questions can be asked based on the content of the speech just made.

c) ***Yield to the Executive Board***: The EB will absorb the time or allocate at their discretion in whatsoever manner they so choose.

Yields are protected speech, and as such, once time has been yielded, that time can neither be yielded again, nor can points be raised on the yielded speech. However, points can still be raised on the original speech after a yield.

Motions

Motions are used to, as the name suggests, “move” the committee from one aspect of debate to another. All procedural motions require a simple majority to pass, i.e 50% + 1 of the total strength of the committee (rounded up in case of an odd number).

Motions have a predetermined template that must be followed, with certain details that mandatorily have to be included.

Motions are voted upon based on the Order of Precedence and Order of Disruption.

A more disruptive motion (a motion that involves a higher number of delegates) will be given priority. In the case where multiple motions are equally disruptive, then the Order of Precedence comes into play, where the motions are voted upon in the order in which they were introduced.

Chits

Chits are a mode of communication between delegates as well as between the delegates and the Executive Board.

There are two types of chits:

- a) ***Informal Chits***: Chits sent from one delegate directly to another delegate without passing through the Executive Board.
- b) ***Formal Chits***: Chits sent from one delegate via the EB to another delegate or between a delegate and the EB. These chits are used for official communication and to send POIs.

Documentation

While there will be a section entirely dedicated to documentation, here are some important things to note.

The Human Rights Council does not have the authority to vet or recognise any external documentation, including any bilateral agreements or Memorandums of Understanding. Considering this fact, we will only be accepting and discussing documentation in the forms of Draft Resolutions, Working Papers, Press Releases or Position Papers.

Two other types of documentation and resolutions are acceptable, namely:

- a) **Decisions:*** these are resolutions that the Human Rights Council passes to accept reports by the Special Procedures of the Human Rights Council.
- b) **Presidential Statements:*** these are letters drafted by the President of the Human Rights Council on behalf of its members detailing the events and discussions that took place during that particular session.

We would also like to make clear that we expect **EVERY** delegate to submit a Position Paper with the following criteria:

- a) Submission Deadline: 12:15 p.m. on 7th August 2026
- b) Handwritten/Printed (Hard Copy) or Digital
- c) If digital, ensure to CC all EB members with the position paper in PDF format.
- d) Maximum Pages: 2 (Only 1 A4 Sheet can be used in total)
- e) Neat and legible handwriting (if handwritten)
- f) Official names to be used, and abbreviations must be written in full the first time it is used.
- g) Refer to the following image for formatting and requirements:

POSITION PAPER



Committee: United Nations Human Rights Council

Agenda:

Country: State of Eritrea

Common Motions

1. The delegate of _____ motions to set the agenda to “[AGENDA]”
2. The delegate of _____ motions to suspend the meeting.
3. The delegate of _____ motions to suspend formal debate and move into an unmoderated caucus for a total time period of _____ minutes.
4. The delegate of _____ motions to suspend formal debate and move into a moderated caucus for a total time period of _____ minutes, with an individual speaker time of _____ seconds, discussing the topic _____.

Consultations

Consultations are a special form of informal debate. They are a modification of moderated caucuses that came to life to provide more freedom to delegates to discuss and argue matters. Consultations are of two types:

- a) Formal Consultations:* Open debate, with a set total time, but no limit on the individual speaker's time, allowing delegates to speak for however long they want to, with some intervention from the Executive Board. Delegates raise their placards to be recognised to speak at a particular moment, i.e delegates will be recognised one at a time to give their statements: no lists are established in advance
- b) Informal Consultations:* Open debate, with a set total time, but no limit on the individual speaker's time, allowing delegates to speak for however long they want to, with minimal intervention from the Executive Board. Delegates decide of their own accord the order of recognition, i.e delegates will give their statements one at a time without formal recognition from the Executive Board: no lists are established in advance

Question and Answer Session

Question and answer sessions are specialised forms of informal debate. It allows delegates to ask each other Points of Information with fewer restrictions and more avenues to ask follow-up

points to help facilitate debate. ~~A question and answer session~~ can be raised to twice per day, for aduration of 30 minutes or less at a time.

Explanation of the Agenda

Introduction:

Artificial intelligence has rapidly evolved from simple technology into a key aspect of modern warfare. It was initially developed for applications like healthcare, finance, transportation, and

daily support, but it is now being used by militaries to identify targets, operate systems, enhance cybersecurity, and support non-peaceful purposes.

AI has the potential to improve military precision and reduce a lot of risk to soldiers, but it also raises a lot of concerns about accountability and transparency, with special regard to the protection of civilians. As AI systems now become more autonomous, the international community faces more questions about whether AI-dominated systems should ever be involved in non-peaceful services, security purposes, or military use, considering the severe lack of clear frameworks and international law that apply to the set technologies so far.

Evolution of AI in warfare:

Technological innovation has always shaped the way nations develop warfare mechanisms, from mechanized weapons during the Industrial Revolution to nuclear weapons and cyber capabilities in the modern era. Artificial intelligence officially represents the next major shift in warfare, and rapid advances in machine learning have now enabled AI to play a more active role in military operations. Major military powers such as the United States, China, Israel, Russia, and several NATO members have made AI a priority, and I now view it as a key aspect of future national security.

Areas for further consideration: Delegates are encouraged to examine the following issues throughout the committee, as well as conduct in-depth research to have a better understanding of what this agenda really entails:

- The compatibility of AI-enabled warfare with international humanitarian law (IHL)
- Accountability for unlawful actions carried out by autonomous weapons and AI-assisted machines in warfare
- The concept of human control over decisions involving the use of force upon citizens
- The regulation of lethal autonomous weapon systems (laws, also known as killer robots)
- The role of private technology companies in developing military AI
- Ongoing discussions within the United Nations, particularly under the Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons (CCW), regarding the international governance of military AI
- The risks posed by AI-driven surveillance, cyber warfare, deepfakes, and algorithmic bias during armed conflict and its impact on the rights of citizens in various nations

Why this agenda matters:

Artificial intelligence reshapes the nature of armed conflict at a pace that now exceeds the development of international legal and regulatory frameworks. While AI does offer a lot of opportunities for nations to develop technologically and improve efficiency and precision, it also creates a lot of risks for human rights. Including the rights, new international law norms or legally binding regulations are necessary to govern such technology, or whether existing frameworks can be effective for the same.

INTRODUCTION TO UNHRC

The United Nations Human Rights Council (UNHRC) is an intergovernmental body within the United Nations system made up of 47 States responsible for the promotion and protection of all human rights around the globe. It can discuss all thematic human rights issues and situations that require its attention throughout the year. It meets at the United Nations Office at Geneva.

The Human Rights Council is the main intergovernmental body within the United Nations responsible for human rights. **Established in 2006** by the General Assembly, *it is responsible for strengthening the promotion and protection of human rights around the globe.*

The Council, **composed of 47 Member States**, provides a multilateral forum to address human rights violations and country situations. It responds to human rights emergencies and makes recommendations on how to better implement human rights on the ground.

The Council benefits from substantive, technical, and secretariat support from the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR). The Human Rights Council replaced the former United Nations Commission on Human Rights.

The Human Rights Council, in numbers from 2006 to 2023, has had ***54 regular sessions held, 36 special sessions held, and 9 urgent debates held. 1,481 resolutions adopted, 60 Special Procedures mandates established, 38 commissions of inquiry and fact-finding missions set up; 123 of the 193 UN Member States have served on the Council.***

WHAT THE COUNCIL DOES

Serves as an international forum for dialogue on human rights issues with UN officials and mandated experts, states, civil society, and other participants.

1. *Adopts resolutions or decisions* during regular sessions that express the will of the international community on given human rights issues or situations. Adopting a resolution sends a strong political signal which can prompt governments to take action to remedy those situations;
2. *Holds crisis meetings* known as special sessions to respond to urgent human rights situations, 36 of which have been held to date;
Reviews the human rights records of all United Nations Member States via the **Universal Periodic Review**;
3. *Appoints the Special Procedures*, independent human rights experts who serve as the eyes and ears of the Council by monitoring situations in specific countries or by looking at specific themes; and
4. *Authorizes commissions of inquiry and fact-finding missions*, which produce hard-hitting evidence on war crimes and crimes against humanity.

COUNCIL MEMBERSHIP AND ELECTIONS

The Human Rights Council consists of 47 Member States elected directly and individually by a majority of the 193 states of the UN General Assembly. Elections take place every year. Seats are equitably distributed among the five UN regional groups, with one-third of the members being renewed each year. Each member serves a three-year term. Membership is limited to two consecutive terms. As of December 2022, 123 of the 193 Member States of the United Nations have served as Council members.

Rotating membership of the Council reflects the UN's diversity and gives it legitimacy when speaking out on human rights violations in all countries. Members commit to upholding human rights and are expected to cooperate fully with the Council. The General Assembly may vote to suspend a member's membership in the case of gross and systematic violations of human rights. The Council has a bureau which consists of a president and four vice-presidents who represent each of the regional groups.

MECHANISMS AND ENTITIES OF THE HUMAN RIGHTS COUNCIL

The role, principles, objectives, and methods of the Council's main subsidiary bodies are outlined in its "**Institution-building package**" (resolution 5/1), which it adopted in June 2007, one year after its first meeting. The main subsidiary bodies of the Council are:

Universal Periodic Review: The Universal Periodic Review (UPR) is a unique mechanism of the Human Rights Council that calls for each UN Member State to undergo a peer review of its human rights records every 4.5 years. Since its first cycle in 2008, all 193 UN Member States have been reviewed three times. The fourth cycle of the review began in November 2022, at the 41st session of the UPR Working Group.

Special Procedures: The Council also establishes independent experts known as Special Procedures. The Council mandates, nominates, selects, and appoints the respective mandate holders – be they individuals or groups of individuals. These independent experts report annually to the Council from both thematic and country-specific perspectives.

Advisory Committee: Composed of 18 independent experts, the Committee functions as the Council's think tank and helps set its directions on thematic issues.

Complaint Procedure: The complaint procedure of the Human Rights Council addresses consistent patterns of gross and reliably attested violations of all human rights and fundamental freedoms occurring in any part of the world and under any circumstances. Complaints may be submitted by individuals, groups, or non-governmental organizations that claim to be victims of such violations, or who have direct, reliable knowledge of them.

HRC-mandated investigations

United Nations-mandated investigative bodies serve as crucial tools for addressing serious violations of international humanitarian law and human rights law, whether arising suddenly or from protracted conflicts. *These independent mechanisms, established by various entities*

including the Security Council, General Assembly, Secretary-General, and Human Rights Council, aim to promote accountability and counter impunity.

Investigative bodies mandated by the Human Rights Council have taken numerous forms since the Council was created in 2006, including fact-finding missions and commissions of inquiry. Most have been established to investigate alleged violations in specific countries.

Designated Experts of the UN High Commissioner for Human Rights

Through a resolution, the Human Rights Council can request the UN High Commissioner for Human Rights to designate experts who document and report on human rights situations. To date, the Council has asked the High Commissioner to designate experts for three countries: Sudan, Haiti, and Colombia.

Open-ended intergovernmental working groups

Open-ended intergovernmental working groups elaborate and/or negotiate and finalize new draft legal instruments. They also make recommendations on the effective implementation of existing instruments.

Current groups include:

1. Working Group on the Right to Development
2. Intergovernmental Working Group on the Durban Declaration and Programme of
3. Action Ad Hoc Committee on the Elaboration of Complementary Standards
4. Open-ended intergovernmental working group on regulatory framework of activities of private military and security companies
5. Open-ended intergovernmental working group on transnational corporations and other business enterprises with respect to human rights
6. Open-ended intergovernmental working group on an optional protocol to the Convention on the Rights of the Child on the rights to early childhood education, free pre-primary education and free secondary education
7. Other open-ended intergovernmental working groups have completed their mandates.

Expert Mechanisms

Subsidiary expert mechanisms provide the Council with thematic expertise, focused mainly on studies, research-based advice or best practices. Supported by the thematic division of the Office of the High Commissioner of Human Rights, they meet and report annually to the Council.

1. Expert Mechanism on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples
2. Expert Mechanism on the Right to Development

Forums

The Council establishes forums as platforms for dialogue and cooperation. There are five of these events, all of them organized yearly except for the Forum on Human Rights, Democracy and the Rule of Law, which is held every two years. Learn more.

1. Forum on Minority Issues
2. Social Forum
3. Forum on Business and Human Rights
4. Forum on Human Rights, Democracy and the Rule of Law
5. Permanent Forum on People of African Descent

PAST RESOLUTIONS

Principle	Resolution	Date Adopted	Origin Body	Key Provisions	Official UN Document Reader
Seizing the opportunities of safe, secure and trustworthy Artificial Intelligence	A/RES/78/265	21 March 2024	General Assembly Plenary Session	First-ever global UN resolution on AI. Calls for AI that is safe, secure, trustworthy,	https://docs.un.org/en/A/RES/78/265

systems for sustainable development				human-rights compliant, and aligned with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).	
Enhancing international cooperation on capacity-building of Artificial Intelligence	A/RES/78/311	1 July 2024	General Assembly Plenary Session	Focuses on helping developing countries build AI capacity, reducing the digital divide, technology transfer, and international cooperation. Addresses military	https://docs.un.org/en/A/RES/78/311
Artificial intelligence in the military domain and its implications for international peace and security	A/RES/79/239	24 December 2024	DISEC	AI, autonomous weapons, international humanitarian law, accountability, and responsible military use of AI. Promotes AI cooperation for sustainable	https://docs.un.org/en/A/RES/79/239
The role of Artificial Intelligence in creating new opportunities for sustainable development in Central Asia	A/RES/79/322	25 July 2025	General Assembly Plenary Session	development, digital infrastructure, education, innovation, and regional	https://docs.un.org/en/A/RES/79/322

				cooperation in Central Asia.	
Terms of Reference and Modalities for the Establishment and Functioning of the Independent International Scientific Panel on Artificial Intelligence and the Global Dialogue on Artificial Intelligence Governance	A/RES/79/325	26 August 2025	General Assembly Plenary Session	Establishes the Independent International Scientific Panel on AI and the Global Dialogue on AI Governance , creating the UN's institutional mechanism for global AI governance.	https://docs.un.org/en/A/RES/79/325
Artificial intelligence in the military domain and its implications for international peace and security.	A/RES/80/58	1 December 2025	DISEC	Expands previous military AI discussions; calls for responsible use, transparency, human oversight, confidence-building measures, and compliance with international law.	https://docs.un.org/en/A/RES/80/58
Possible risks of the integration of Artificial Intelligence into command, control and communications	A/RES/80/23	1 December 2025	DISEC	Warns against integrating AI into nuclear command-and-control systems; emphasizes maintaining meaningful	https://docs.un.org/en/A/RES/80/23

systems of nuclear weapons				human control over nuclear weapons decisions.	
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WEST ASIA CONFLICTS

Israel-Palestine

The conflict is a century-long dispute over land, sovereignty, and national identity in the Levant. It traces its modern roots to the late 19th-century rise of Zionism and the subsequent British Mandate for Palestine. The 1947 UN Partition Plan (Resolution 181) proposed separate Jewish and Arab states, which led to the 1948 Arab-Israeli War, the establishment of Israel, and the displacement of over 700,000 Palestinians (the *Nakba*). Despite the 1993 Oslo Accords establishing the Palestinian Authority (PA) for limited self-governance, continuous settlement expansion, the blockade of Gaza since 2007, and the absence of a viable path to a two-state solution have entrenched a cycle of systemic violence, only escalating after the 7th October Hamas attacks.

Over 80% of Gaza's housing, water sanitation networks, and electrical grids have been systematically leveled or deactivated. Critical shortages of anesthetics, antibiotics, and clean water have crippled the remaining functional hospitals, leaving thousands of chronic and trauma patients without care. In the West Bank, forced evictions, punitive home demolitions, and expanding illegal settlements have displaced thousands of Palestinians, fueled by armed settler excursions.

This theater marks the first extensive deployment of AI-driven military targeting systems. Platforms such as "The Gospel" and "Lavender" use machine learning to process mass surveillance data, cell phone records, and social media feeds to generate vast target lists at unprecedented speeds. UN investigators note that this automation compresses the timeline for human verification, significantly raising the risk of civilian casualties and creating deep accountability gaps regarding international humanitarian law (IHL).

Syria

The crisis began in March 2011 with peaceful pro-democracy protests in Deraa, inspired by the Arab Spring. The violent crackdown by President Bashar al-Assad's regime transformed the popular uprising into a multi-sided civil war. Over the years, the conflict fractured along ethnic, sectarian, and political lines, drawing in foreign militaries (Russia, Iran, Turkey, and the US) and

giving rise to extremist groups like ISIS. Following fifteen years of war, a rapid domestic opposition offensive fractured the long-standing Ba'athist regime's control, triggering a complex transition of power.

Following the collapse of the Assad regime, Syria is undergoing a precarious political transition. While the transitional government in Damascus attempts to present a moderate, inclusive platform to secure international recognition, deep structural fault lines remain. Tensions between Damascus and the Kurdish-led SDF over regional autonomy persist, while Turkish troops maintain a presence in the north, and Israeli forces enforce strict buffer zones in the south to prevent hostile elements from consolidating power.

AI application in Syria is defined by decentralized drone warfare and digital surveillance. Various factions utilize low-cost commercial drones modified with AI-enabled facial recognition and autonomous flight pathing to bypass electronic jamming. Additionally, the transitional government and local militias use automated social media monitoring algorithms to scan public platforms, track political dissidents, and map potential domestic opposition.

Yemen

The conflict grew out of a failed political transition following the 2011 Arab Spring, which forced long-time President Ali Abdullah Saleh to cede power to his deputy, Abdrabbuh Mansour Hadi. Capitalizing on widespread public discontent with the new government's corruption and insecurity, the Houthi movement (Ansar Allah)—a Zaydi Shia militant group from northern Yemen—seized the capital, Sanaa, in late 2014. In early 2015, a Saudi-led coalition intervened militarily to restore the internationally recognized government, initiating a prolonged proxy conflict that shattered Yemen's infrastructure.

The formal peace process remains deadlocked. The PLC has consolidated some authority across southern provinces with Saudi assistance, but internal divisions between the government and the secessionist STC complicate governance. While large-scale aerial bombardments by the Saudi coalition have largely ceased, localized ground skirmishes occur along the Marib and Taiz frontlines, running parallel to the Houthis' ongoing maritime campaigns in the Red Sea.

AI implementation in Yemen is primarily seen in the tactical systems of Houthi uncrewed aerial vehicles (UAVs) and loitering munitions. Supplied with tech components from external networks, these drones utilize basic machine-vision algorithms for autonomous terminal guidance, allowing them to home in on fixed infrastructure targets or naval vessels without active radio control links, rendering traditional electronic warfare jamming less effective.

Iran–Israel

Following the 1979 Islamic Revolution, Iran adopted a staunchly anti-Zionist stance, viewing Israel as an illegitimate state and a tool of Western imperialism. For decades, the two nations engaged in a low-intensity shadow war: Iran built and funded an axis of regional proxy groups (Hezbollah, Hamas, Houthis), while Israel engaged in targeted assassinations of Iranian nuclear scientists and cyber-sabotage campaigns (such as the Stuxnet virus). This shadow war burst into the open with direct, large-scale interstate military strikes involving ballistic missiles, cruise missiles, and combat drones.

The conflict features volatile cycles of direct military strikes and fragile, brief ceasefires. Strategic choke points, particularly the Strait of Hormuz, face frequent blockades and vessel seizures by the IRGC, inflating global energy prices. Internal political shifts and leadership disruptions within Iran add an extra layer of unpredictability to its regional command structure.

This interstate conflict represents a highly sophisticated AI-driven theater. Israel relies heavily on AI-integrated multi-layered defense networks (Iron Dome, David's Sling, Arrow 3) that use predictive modeling to instantly calculate intercept trajectories for hundreds of incoming projectiles simultaneously. Conversely, offensive operations on both sides employ AI-driven cyber weapons capable of mapping software vulnerabilities in critical national infrastructure and deploying self-propagating malware without human intervention.

Lebanon

The conflict dates back to the presence of Palestinian fedayeen in Lebanon during the late 1960s, leading to Israel's full-scale invasions in 1978 and 1982 to neutralize armed factions. Hezbollah, a Shia Islamist militant group and political party, emerged in the early 1980s with Iranian backing to resist the Israeli occupation, which ended in 2000. Following a major 34-day war in 2006, UN Security Council Resolution 1701 mandated a demilitarized zone between the Blue Line and the Litani River. However, Hezbollah systematically remilitarized the region, leading to renewed border conflict.

High-intensity combat persists along the border. Israeli forces maintain tactical security corridors inside southern Lebanese territory, executing operations aimed at destroying Hezbollah's tunnel networks and launch facilities. Diplomatic efforts focused on a permanent cessation of hostilities remain stalled, as Hezbollah refuses to withdraw its forces north of the Litani River without a comprehensive regional settlement.

The IDF uses AI-driven sensor fusion systems to counter Hezbollah's asymmetric tactics. By combining real-time satellite imagery, acoustic gunshot detection data, and thermal feeds from high-altitude drones, these systems instantaneously identify the exact launch coordinates of hidden mobile rocket launchers. This data is fed directly to automated artillery batteries, allowing for counter-battery fire within seconds of a launch.

Red Sea

The conflict developed directly from the regional escalation of the Gaza war. In late 2023, the Houthi movement in Yemen declared its intention to target any commercial or military vessels in the Red Sea linked to Israel, or those bound for Israeli ports, as an act of solidarity with the Palestinian population. The Red Sea is an essential global maritime artery, carrying roughly 12% of international trade and 30% of global container traffic via the Bab al-Mandab Strait. The persistent attacks forced a major international maritime security crisis.

The Red Sea remains a contested naval combat zone. Despite continuous counter-strikes by US and British naval assets targeting Houthi radar installations, coastal launch pads, and underground storage facilities in western Yemen, the Houthis retain the capability to launch asymmetric strikes. Most major commercial shipping firms continue to avoid the Suez Canal route, opting for longer, more expensive alternative passages.

The Red Sea conflict highlights a stark contrast in AI applications. The Houthis deploy low-cost, AI-enabled autonomous underwater vehicles (AUVs) and surface drones that use basic computer vision to identify the hull profiles of large ships for ramming attacks. Naval coalitions respond with highly advanced AI combat management systems, such as Aegis, which autonomously categorize, prioritize, and track hundreds of fast-moving aerial and surface threats in real-time, recommending optimal interception options to human commanders.

Kurdish

The Kurdish people constitute a distinct Indo-European ethnic group of roughly 35 to 40 million people, split across Turkey, Syria, Iraq, and Iran following the post-WWI dissolution of the Ottoman Empire. Lacking a sovereign state, Kurdish groups have pursued autonomy or independence through both political and armed struggles. The Kurdistan Workers' Party (PKK) launched an armed insurgency against the Turkish state in 1984, demanding Kurdish autonomy. The conflict expanded into northern Iraq and northern Syria, where Kurdish groups established autonomous regions amid broader state instability.

The conflict is defined by complex multi-front dynamics. In Turkey, tentative discussions regarding a domestic peace process occur alongside ongoing military operations. In northern Syria, Kurdish autonomous structures face pressure from the new transitional Syrian government in Damascus and Turkish forces. In western Iran, Iranian security forces carry out targeted campaigns against Kurdish opposition groups amid widespread domestic unrest.

The Turkish military utilizes an advanced AI-driven drone doctrine to conduct counter-insurgency operations. Platforms like the Bayraktar TB2 and Akinci use AI-enabled signals intelligence (SIGINT) algorithms to intercept, decrypt, and geolocate satellite phone and

radio transmissions among mountainous terrain. This automated tracking allows for immediate, targeted drone strikes against suspected command cells deep within remote mountain hideouts.

ISIS

The Islamic State of Iraq and Syria (ISIS) grew out of Al-Qaeda in Iraq, capitalizing on the sectarian tensions following the 2003 US invasion of Iraq and the chaos of the 2011 Syrian civil war. In 2014, the group captured vast territories across both nations, declaring a global "caliphate" centered in Raqqa and ruling over millions with extreme brutality. Although a global coalition militarily dismantled its territorial caliphate by 2019, ISIS successfully transitioned back into a decentralized network of clandestine insurgent cells, maintaining an asymmetric low-level conflict.

The insurgency operates primarily in the remote Badia Desert of Syria and the disputed territories of northern Iraq. ISIS avoids holding permanent ground, relying instead on hit-and-run tactics, roadside improvised explosive devices (IEDs), and targeted assassinations of local village leaders. This ongoing security threat occurs alongside the gradual drawdown of international coalition forces, shifting primary responsibility onto local militaries.

State security forces rely heavily on predictive policing and digital surveillance tools to combat the underground nature of ISIS cells. AI algorithms scan thousands of hours of commercial thermal drone footage to detect anomalies in desert terrain, mapping hidden underground bunkers or cave entrances. Security agencies also use automated NLP (Natural Language Processing) tools to track and disrupt encrypted communication channels used for propaganda distribution and financial transfers.

QUESTIONS A RESOLUTION MUST ANSWER (QARMA)

1. How can the use of AI-enabled warfare be regulated to ensure the protection of fundamental human rights and freedoms during armed conflicts?
2. How can civilians in conflict zones be effectively protected from human rights violations arising from AI-assisted targeting and autonomous weapons systems?
3. Recommendations on establishing accountability and legal mechanisms for human rights violations resulting from AI-enabled and autonomous military operations.
4. How can meaningful human oversight and due process be ensured in the development and deployment of artificial intelligence in armed conflicts, particularly in West Asia?

5. How can international mechanisms be strengthened to ensure that AI-enabled warfare does not disproportionately affect vulnerable populations, including children, refugees, and displaced persons?
6. Recommendations on the establishment of international standards governing the responsible development and use of artificial intelligence in warfare, with special emphasis on the protection of civilians and human rights in West Asia.

Good Luck! :)

